

Question:

A mental health volunteer is interviewing locals as part of a community outreach program. A 46-year-old man discloses that he has felt sad for as long as he can remember. He feels as though his life is cursed and if something terrible can happen to him, it usually will. He has difficulty making decisions and feels hopeless. He also feels that he has had worsening suicidal ideations, guilt from past problems, energy, and concentration over the past 2 weeks. He is otherwise getting enough sleep and able to hold a job. Which of the following statement best describes this patient's condition?

Answer Choices:

- A. The patient is at risk for double depression.
- B. The patient may have symptoms of mania or psychosis.
- C. The patient is likely to show anhedonia.
- D. The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder.

Reasoning + Answer:

<think> To answer this question, we need to look at the patient's symptoms and behavior.

The patient is experiencing symptoms of depression, including feeling sad to the point where he thinks his life is cursed, difficulty making decisions, and worsening suicidal ideations over the past 2 weeks. These symptoms are consistent with a diagnosis of depression.

The patient's symptoms are not indicative of mania or psychosis, as there is no mention of abnormal energy or concentration that is typically associated with these conditions.

The patient's symptoms are also not consistent with paranoid personality disorder, as this condition is typically characterized by a pattern of suspicious and aggressive behavior, which is not evident in the patient's description.

The patient's symptoms are also consistent with the idea that he is at risk for double depression, which is a condition that is often characterized by a combination of depression and anxiety.

Therefore, based on the patient's symptoms and behavior, it is likely that he is at risk for double depression.</think><answer> The patient is at risk for double depression. </answer>

